Answer Key

25901518

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION March 2026

Fourth SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Elective (DSE) - MG4DSESSV200 - BHASHAASASTRAM

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Remember (K), Understand (U), Apply(A), Analyse (An), Evaluate (E), Create (C), Skill (S), Interest (I) and Appreciation (Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Part A

One or two sentence questions

Answer any 10 questions

Each question carries 1 mark

1. Which branch of linguistics deals with sentence construction?

   Syntax deals with sentence construction and structure.

2. What is Adam's apple?

   The Adam's apple is the protrusion formed by the thyroid cartilage of the larynx in the throat.

3. What is Organic change?

   Organic change is a sound change caused by the natural development and evolution of a language over time.

4. What is the definition of analogy according to Bloomfield?

   According to Leonard Bloomfield, analogy is the process by which forms are changed to become similar to other forms in the language.

5. Write Tucker's definition of Phonetic law.

   According to Tucker, a phonetic law is a regular and consistent change affecting speech sounds under specific conditions.

6. Name some languages of the Indo-European family.

Examples include English, Hindi, Sanskrit, German, French, Greek, Latin, and Persian.

7. What is called a closed vowel?

A closed vowel (high vowel) is produced when the tongue is raised close to the roof of the mouth, such as /i/ in *see* and /u/ in *food*.

8. What are the causes of semantic change?

Causes include:

- Historical changes
- Social changes
- Psychological factors
- Cultural influences
- Linguistic factors

9. State Grassmann's Law of De-aspiration.

Grassmann's Law states that when two aspirated sounds occur in successive syllables, the first loses its aspiration.

10. How are the relations of words expressed in isolating languages?

In isolating languages, word relations are expressed mainly through word order and separate function words, not by inflections.

11. Which branch of linguistics deals with the production of speech sounds?

Phonetics

12. How the dialects are originated?

Divergence

(1x10=10)

Part B

Paragraph questions

Answer any 6 questions

Each question carries 5 marks

13. Write the Sanskrit consonants.

क ख ग घ ङ
च छ ज झ ञ

ट ठ ड ढ ण
त थ द ध न
प फ ब भ म
य र ल व
श ष स ह

14. What is called Apocope and Anaptyxis? Explain with examples.

Apocope: Loss of a sound or syllable at the end of a word.

Examples:

- *photograph → photo*
- *memorandum → memo*

Anaptyxis: Addition of a vowel between two consonants to ease pronunciation.

Examples:

- *film → filum*
- *athlete → athalete*

15. What is Haplology? Give examples.

Haplology is the omission of one of two similar or identical syllables occurring close together.

Examples:

- *library → libry*
- *probably → probly*
- *humbly* from *humblely*

16. State the aim and objectives of Comparative Philology.

Aim: To study the historical relationship among languages.

Objectives:

1. To compare related languages.
2. To discover common origins.
3. To reconstruct the parent language.
4. To trace sound changes.
5. To explain linguistic evolution.

17. What are the two types of suffixes? Explain with examples.

1. Inflectional Suffixes

- Show grammatical meaning.
- Examples: *boys*, *walked*, *playing*.

2. Derivational Suffixes

- Form new words.
- Examples: *kind* → *kindness*, *teach* → *teacher*, *happy* → *happiness*.

18. Explain the two-fold classification of linguistic change.

1. Organic Change

- Natural change occurring in language over time.
- Example: Sound changes in pronunciation.

2. Analogical Change

- Change caused by the influence of similar forms.
- Example: *helped* formed on the pattern of other past tense verbs.

19. Describe Fortunatov's Law with examples.

Fortunatov's Law states that in Sanskrit, an aspirated consonant loses its aspiration when another aspirated consonant follows in the next syllable.

Examples:

- *bhudh* → *budh*
- Similar de-aspiration occurs to avoid two aspirates in succession.

20. Explain Formal Analogy with examples.

Formal Analogy is a change in word form based on the pattern of similar words.

Examples:

- *cow : cows* influenced the formation of *book : books*.
- Irregular forms becoming regular, such as *helped* following the pattern of regular verbs.

21. What is Historical and Comparative Study of Linguistics?

The historical and comparative study of linguistics examines the development of languages through time and compares related languages to discover their common origin.

Main features:

1. Studies language change over time.
2. Compares related languages.
3. Reconstructs parent languages.
4. Explains sound and meaning changes.
5. Establishes language families such as the Indo-European family.

This branch is also known as Comparative Philology or Historical Linguistics.

(5x6=30)

Part C

Answer any 2 questions

Answer any 10 questions

Each question carries 15 marks

22. How are the Aryan languages classified into Centum and Satam groups?

The Indo-European (Aryan) languages are divided into Centum and Satam groups based on the development of the original palatal consonants.

Centum Group

In these languages, the palatal consonants changed into velar sounds (k, g).

Examples:

- Latin
- Greek
- Celtic
- Germanic

The word for "hundred" in Latin is centum, pronounced with a "k" sound, hence the name *Centum*.

Satam Group

In these languages, the palatal consonants changed into sibilant sounds (s, sh).

Examples:

- Sanskrit
- Avestan
- Persian
- Balto-Slavic languages

The Sanskrit word for "hundred" is satam, hence the name *Satam*.

Importance

1. Helps classify Indo-European languages.
2. Shows historical sound changes.
3. Reveals relationships among languages.
4. Assists in reconstructing the parent language.

Thus, the Centum-Satam division is an important principle in comparative philology.

23. State how speech sounds are classified in linguistics.

Speech sounds are studied under phonetics and are mainly classified into vowels and consonants.

1. Vowels

Vowels are produced without obstruction to the airflow.

They are classified according to:

- Height of the tongue (high, mid, low)
- Position of the tongue (front, central, back)
- Shape of the lips (rounded, unrounded)

Examples:

- /i/ as in *see*
- /u/ as in *food*
- /a/ as in *father*

2. Consonants

Consonants are produced with some obstruction of airflow.

They are classified according to:

a) Place of Articulation

- Bilabial (p, b)
- Dental (t, d)
- Alveolar (s, z)
- Velar (k, g)

b) Manner of Articulation

- Stops (p, t, k)
- Fricatives (f, s)
- Nasals (m, n)
- Liquids (l, r)

c) Voicing

- Voiced (b, d, g)
- Voiceless (p, t, k)

24. Write an essay on the classification of semantic change.

Semantic change is the process by which the meanings of words change over time.

Types of Semantic Change

1. Widening (Extension)

The meaning becomes broader.

Examples:

- *Dog* once referred to a particular breed but now means any dog.
- *Holiday* originally meant a religious festival and now means any vacation.

2. Narrowing (Specialization)

The meaning becomes more restricted.

Examples:

- *Meat* originally meant food in general; now it refers to animal flesh.
- *Deer* once meant any animal; now it means a specific animal.

3. Amelioration

The meaning improves or becomes more favourable.

Examples:

- *Knight* originally meant servant; now it denotes honor and rank.

4. Pejoration

The meaning deteriorates or becomes less favourable.

Examples:

- *Villain* originally meant farm worker; now it means a wicked person.

5. Metaphorical Change

Meaning changes through similarity.

Examples:

- *Head* of a person → *head* of an institution.
- *Foot* of a person → *foot* of a mountain.

6. Metonymic Change

Meaning changes through association.

Examples:

- *The Crown* for the king or queen.
- *The White House* for the U.S. government.

Causes of Semantic Change

1. Historical changes
2. Social changes
3. Psychological factors
4. Cultural developments
5. Linguistic influences

25. Explain Verner's Law with examples.

Verner's Law was discovered by Karl Verner in 1875. It explains certain exceptions to Grimm's Law in the Germanic languages.

Statement of the Law

According to Verner's Law, the voiceless fricatives produced by Grimm's Law became voiced when the preceding syllable was not accented in Proto-Indo-European.

The changes are:

- f → b
- þ (th) → d
- h → g
- s → z

Examples

1. Sanskrit bhrātar → English brother
    - The *th* sound became voiced because the stress did not fall on the preceding syllable.

2. Sanskrit pitar → English father
3. Sanskrit śata → Gothic hund
4. Latin frater → English brother

Importance of Verner's Law

1. Explains exceptions to Grimm's Law.
2. Shows the role of stress in sound change.
3. Supports the regularity of sound laws.
4. Helps reconstruct Proto-Indo-European forms.

(15x2=30)